Mishaps App — Scenario Content for Review

Oct 31, 2026 · @Susan

How to read this doc

This doc holds the wording for the app's first 10 scenarios, for review before it goes into the app. Each scenario has four parts:

- **Help Now steps:** what the app shows, one step per screen. Indented lines are branches the app asks about with Yes/No buttons.
- **Anxious-mode lines:** reassurance shown only when she taps "I'm really anxious."
- **Practice:** a "What would you do?" question with choices. Each choice is marked **Right**, **Not first** (reasonable but out of order), or **Not this** (with what to do instead). **Never** marks a dangerous instinct, shown with firmer styling.
- **Calls:** who the app suggests calling, from her call list.

Call list used throughout

Who	Role in the app
Mom	First call
Dad	Second call
Aunt	Can coach by phone; can come help (about 30 min)
911	Fire, smoke, gas, CO, anyone hurt badly, feeling in danger
Specialists	Plumber, NOVEC outage line (703-335-0500), Washington Gas emergency leak line (844-927-4427, option 1), bank card line

What reviewers should check

- Is each step something she can actually do, in words she'd understand under stress?
- Do the anxious-mode lines sound like something that would calm *her*?
- Are the wrong practice choices the mistakes she'd really be tempted to make?
- Anything missing, too long, or in the wrong order?

1. Smoke alarm going off or chirping

The first question is which sound it is: a loud, repeating alarm means get out unless she knows it's cooking smoke; a single chirp every 30–60 seconds is a low battery and not an emergency.

Help Now steps

1. Listen. Is it a loud beep-beep-beep that keeps going, or one short chirp every minute or so?
   - **Short chirp:** go to step 6.
   - **Loud, repeating alarm:** go to step 2.
2. Do you see flames, or is smoke filling the room?
   - **Yes, or I'm not sure:** go to step 3.
   - **No, I know it's from cooking (like burnt toast) and nothing is burning now:** go to step 5.
3. Get out now. Leave everything. Close doors behind you if you can.
   - If there's smoke on the way, stay low and go under it.
   - If a closed door feels hot, don't open it. Use another way out.
4. Once outside, call 911. Then call Mom or Dad. Stay out until firefighters say it's safe. Never go back in, not for pets or things.
5. Cooking smoke: turn off the stove, open a window, and turn on the stove fan. Wave a towel near the alarm to clear the smoke. If the alarm doesn't stop in a few minutes, or you smell burning you can't find, go back to step 3.
6. Chirping: this means the battery is low. It's not a fire.
7. Tell Mom or Dad which alarm is chirping. They'll change the battery or the alarm. Don't take the alarm down yourself.

Anxious-mode lines

- (Chirp) "That sound is annoying, but it's just the alarm asking for a new battery. You're safe."
- (Alarm) "Your only job right now is to get outside. Everything else can wait."
- (Outside) "You did exactly the right thing. Firefighters handle the rest."

Practice: "The smoke alarm is beeping loudly and you see smoke in the hallway. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Get out, staying low under the smoke, then call 911	Right	Yes. Getting out comes first, and smoke rises, so the cleaner air is low.
Call 911 from inside	Not first	Call from outside. Every second inside counts.
Grab my phone, laptop and cat first	Never	Leave everything. Things can be replaced; firefighters will look for pets.
Hide in my room until it stops	Never	Never hide. Get outside, even if it's scary.

Practice: "One alarm makes a short chirp every minute. What does that mean?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
The battery is low; tell Mom or Dad	Right	Yes. It's a reminder, not an emergency.
There's a fire somewhere; get out	Not this	A fire alarm is loud and nonstop. One chirp a minute is the battery.
Pull the alarm off the ceiling	Not this	Leave it up. An alarm with no battery can't warn anyone.

Calls: 911 (from outside) for any fire or smoke. Mom, then Dad, for chirping or after 911.

Sources: Red Cross home fire steps · Seattle Fire Dept. home evacuation guide · Chirp causes and NFPA guidance

2. Something burning on the stove

The burner goes off first in every branch; a small fire in a pan gets a lid, and anything bigger than the pan means get out.

Help Now steps

1. Turn the burner off.
2. Are there flames?
   - **No, just smoke:** go to step 3.

   - **Yes, inside the pan only:** go to step 4.
   - **Yes, in the oven or microwave:** go to step 6.
   - **Flames bigger than the pan, or spreading, or I'm not sure:** go to step 7.
3. Smoke only: use an oven mitt to slide the pan onto a cold burner. Open a window and turn on the stove fan. You're done.
4. Flames in the pan: slide a lid over the pan. A baking sheet works too. **Never use water.**
5. Leave the lid on and don't move the pan until it's completely cool. Lifting the lid early can restart the fire. If the fire doesn't go out, go to step 7.
6. Oven or microwave: turn it off and keep the door closed. The fire will go out without air. If it doesn't, go to step 7.
7. Get out. Close the kitchen door behind you if you can. Once outside, call 911, then Mom or Dad.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Burner off first. That one move fixes most of it."
- (Lid on) "Covering it takes away its air. You did it right."
- (Getting out) "Leaving is the brave choice here. Firefighters are fast."

Practice: "Oil in a frying pan catches fire. The flames are just in the pan. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Burner off, slide a lid over the pan	Right	Yes. No air, no fire. Leave the lid on until it's cool.
Pour water on it	Never	**Never put water on a grease fire.** It makes burning oil jump out of the pan. Lid on, burner off.
Carry the pan to the sink	Never	Don't move it. Burning oil can spill on you. Lid on, burner off.
Wait to see if it goes out	Not this	Act right away: burner off, lid on. Small fires grow fast.

Practice: "Something in the oven catches fire. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Turn the oven off and keep the door shut	Right	Yes. With the door shut, the fire runs out of air.
Open the door to see	Not this	Opening it feeds the fire air. Keep it closed.
Throw water in	Never	Keep the door closed instead. Water can spread some fires.

Calls: 911 from outside if it's bigger than the pan or won't go out. Mom or Dad after any fire, even a small one, so they can check the stove.

Sources: NFPA cooking safety (via Ashburn Volunteer Fire-Rescue) · NFPA tip sheet (via K-State) · Cambridge Fire Dept. grease fire tips

3. Sink or tub overflowing

Stopping the water comes before cleaning up: faucet first, then the shutoff valve, then the house's main shutoff if needed.

Help Now steps

1. Turn the faucet off.
2. Did the water stop coming out?
   - **Yes:** go to step 4.
   - **No, the faucet won't turn off:** go to step 3.
3. Turn off the water to it.
   - **Sink:** open the cabinet underneath. Turn both valves to the right (clockwise) until they stop. *(Shows her My Home photo of this sink's valves.)*
   - **Tub, or the sink valves won't turn:** turn off the main water shutoff. *(Shows her My Home photo and note for the main shutoff.)*
4. Pull the stopper or open the drain so the water goes down.
5. If water is on the floor near a plug or anything plugged in, don't touch it. Tell Mom or Dad.
6. Put towels on the floor to soak up the water.
7. Text or call Mom or Dad to let them know, especially if water went under a door or through the floor.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Water on the floor looks bad, but it's fixable. Just the faucet first."
- (Valve) "Right to tighten. Turn it until it stops."
- (Done) "The water's off. Everything else is just cleanup."

Practice: "Water is spilling over the sink onto the floor. What do you do first?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Turn the faucet off	Right	Yes. Stopping the water comes first.
Grab towels for the floor	Not first	Towels help, but the water keeps coming until the faucet is off.
Call Mom or Dad	Not first	Good to do next. Stop the water first; it takes two seconds.
Leave the room	Not this	Overflowing water isn't dangerous. Turning the faucet off fixes most of it.

Practice: "You turned the handle but the faucet keeps running. What now?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Turn the valves under the sink to the right	Right	Yes. Those valves shut off water to just that sink.
Keep twisting the faucet harder	Not this	Forcing it can break it. Use the valves under the sink.
Unplug the drain and wait	Not first	Draining helps, but the water is still coming in. Valves first.

Calls: Mom or Dad once the water is off. A plumber only if the water won't stop at any valve.

Sources: Angi: turning off water under a sink · Rytech: steps after a bathroom flood · HomeAdvisor: small home emergencies

4. Toilet clogged or overflowing

The rule is "don't flush again": stop the water filling the bowl, then plunge, and call for coaching if the plunger doesn't work.

Help Now steps

1. Don't flush again.
2. Is the water in the bowl still rising?
   - **Yes:** go to step 3.
   - **No:** go to step 5.
3. Take the lid off the tank behind the bowl and set it down gently. Lift the floating part up and hold it. That stops new water.
4. While holding it, or right after, turn the valve on the wall behind the toilet to the right until it stops. *(Shows her My Home photo of the toilet valve.)*
5. Wait a few minutes. Often the water slowly goes down on its own.
6. Plunge: put the plunger in the bowl so the cup covers the hole. Push down gently the first time, then push and pull firmly about 10 times, keeping the seal.
7. Did the water drain away with a gurgle?
   - **Yes:** turn the wall valve back to the left, wait for the tank to fill, then flush once to check.
   - **No, after 2 or 3 tries:** stop and call someone to coach you, or wait for Mom or Dad.
8. Clean up: put towels down, wear rubber gloves if you have them, and wash your hands well afterward.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Gross, but not dangerous. Don't flush, and the water stops rising."
- (Plunging) "It often takes a few tries. That's normal."
- (Stuck) "It's fine to stop here and get help. It'll keep until then."

Practice: "You flush and the water rises toward the top of the bowl. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Lift the float in the tank, then turn off the wall valve	Right	Yes. That stops new water from coming in.

Choice	Result	Feedback
Flush again to push it through	Not this	**Don't flush again.** Each flush adds more water, which goes on the floor.
Start plunging right away	Not first	Plunging works best once the water stops rising. Float and valve first.
Pour drain cleaner in	Not this	Skip chemical cleaners. They can splash and burn and rarely fix a toilet clog.

Calls: Mom, Dad, or Aunt to coach by phone if plunging doesn't work. A plumber only if the clog won't clear for anyone.

Sources: Benjamin Franklin Plumbing: overflowing toilet · Len the Plumber: stopping an overflow · HomeAdvisor: small home emergencies

5. Power went out

Looking outside tells her which kind it is: if the neighbors are dark too, it's an outage to wait out; if only part of the house is dark, it's usually a tripped breaker she can reset.

Help Now steps

1. Stay where you are for a moment. Turn on your phone's flashlight. Don't light candles.
2. Look out a window. Are the neighbors' houses or streetlights dark too?
   - **Yes, everyone's out:** go to step 3.
   - **No, only our house is dark:** go to step 6.
   - **Only one room or some outlets are dead:** go to step 7.
3. It's a power outage. Text Mom or Dad so they can report it to NOVEC. If neither answers, call NOVEC yourself at 703-335-0500; the number is in My People. Don't call 911 for an outage alone.
4. Keep the fridge and freezer closed. Food stays cold about 4 hours in a closed fridge.
5. Unplug the computer and TV so a power surge can't hurt them. Leave one lamp switched on so you'll know when power is back. If you see a wire down outside, stay far away and call 911.
6. Only our house: call Mom or Dad. It may be the main switch in the breaker panel, which they should check.

7. One room: unplug whatever you were just using (hair dryer, space heater). Then go to the breaker panel. *(Shows her My Home photo.)*
8. Find the switch that's pointing a different way from the others. Push it all the way to OFF, then back to ON.
    - **Power's back:** you're done. Plug things back in one at a time.
    - **It flips off again, or you smell burning:** leave it off and call Mom or Dad.

Anxious-mode lines

- "The dark is just dark. Phone flashlight on, and you're okay."
- (Outage) "Outages happen to the whole street. Crews are already working on it."
- (Breaker) "This switch is made to be flipped. You can't hurt anything by doing it."

Practice: "The lights go out in your bedroom, but the hallway lights still work. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Unplug what I was using, then reset the switch in the breaker panel	Right	Yes. One room out usually means a tripped breaker.
Call the power company	Not this	The rest of the house has power, so it's a breaker, not an outage.
Keep plugging things back in to test	Not this	Unplug first. Whatever tripped it may trip it again.

Practice: "The whole street is dark and it's getting cold. What should you NOT do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Turn on the gas stove to warm the kitchen	Never	**Never heat the house with the stove or oven.** It can fill the air with poison gas you can't smell. Add layers and call Mom, Dad, or Aunt.
Put on a sweater and blanket	Right (allowed)	Good. Layers keep you warm safely.
Keep the fridge closed	Right (allowed)	Good. It keeps food cold longer.

Calls: Mom or Dad for any outage, so they can report it. Aunt can come get her if it's cold or dark for a long time. 911 only for a downed wire, fire, or burning smell.

Sources: Ready.gov power outages · ReadyWisconsin power outage tips

6. Locked out of home

Locked out is inconvenient, not dangerous: she checks the other doors, calls down the list, and waits somewhere comfortable until someone brings a key.

Help Now steps

1. Check the other ways in: back door, garage door, any door you know is sometimes left unlocked. *(Uses My Home note, e.g. garage keypad.)* Don't climb through a window.
2. Call Mom, then Dad. If neither answers, call Aunt; she can come with a key in about 30 minutes.
3. Is it cold, dark, raining, or do you feel unsafe where you are?
   - **No:** wait near the front door, or sit somewhere comfortable nearby.
   - **Yes:** go somewhere warm and public to wait, like a store or the library, or a neighbor you know. Tell whoever's coming where you are.
4. Don't call a locksmith you find online unless Mom or Dad says to. Some charge far more than they quote.
5. If someone makes you feel unsafe, go into a busy store, or call 911.

Anxious-mode lines

- "This happens to everyone. Someone will bring a key."
- (Waiting) "You've called for help. Now you just wait somewhere comfortable."

Practice: "You get home and realize your keys are inside. Nobody's home. What do you do first?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Check the other doors, then call down the list	Right	Yes. Another door may be open, and someone on your list can bring a key.
Search online for a locksmith	Not first	Call family first. Many online locksmith ads quote a low price and then charge much more.

Choice	Result	Feedback
Climb in through a window	Not this	Windows are easy to fall from or break. Call for a key instead.
Sit outside for hours, even though it's freezing	Not this	You don't have to wait in the cold. Go somewhere warm and tell people where you are.

Calls: Mom, then Dad, then Aunt (can bring a key). 911 only if she feels unsafe.

Sources: FTC: Finding a locksmith (archived)

7. Wrong train or bus, or missed my stop

The fix is almost always "get off at the next stop and ride back the other way," and with her SmarTrip card the ride back on a local bus is free within 2 hours.

Help Now steps

1. Stay seated and calm. Nothing bad happens from going one stop too far.
2. Are you on a Metro train or a bus?
   - **Train:** go to step 3.
   - **Bus:** go to step 6.
3. Train: get off at the next station. Don't pull any emergency handle to get off early.
4. Follow the signs to trains going the other direction. Trains are named by their last stop, so look for the name at the end of the line you came from. You don't need to go out through the fare gates.
5. Not sure which platform? Ask the station manager in the booth near the gates. That's their job.
6. Bus: press the yellow strip or pull the cord to ask for the next stop, and get off there.
7. Cross the street at a crosswalk and wait at the stop on the other side for a bus going back the way you came. With your SmarTrip card, a local bus back is free within 2 hours.
8. Feeling unsure where you are, or it's getting dark? Order an Uber home instead, or call Mom, Dad, or Aunt.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Riders miss stops every day. You just go back one stop."

- (Asking staff) "Station staff help lost riders all day. You won't bother them."
- (Uber) "Taking an Uber is a fine answer. You don't have to figure it all out."

Practice: "The Metro doors close and you realize the train is going the wrong way. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Get off at the next station and take a train back the other way	Right	Yes. It just costs a few minutes.
Pull the emergency handle to stop the train	Never	**Emergency handles are only for emergencies.** Missing a stop isn't one. Ride to the next station.
Stay on until the end of the line	Not this	That takes you much farther. Get off at the very next stop.
Leave through the fare gates and pay again	Not this	No need. You can switch platforms inside the station.

Practice: "You were looking at your phone and the bus passed your stop. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Press for the next stop, get off, and catch the bus back across the street	Right	Yes. With SmarTrip, that ride back is free within 2 hours.
Ask the driver to stop right now between stops	Not this	Drivers can only stop at bus stops. Press for the next one.
Stay on and hope it loops back	Not this	Many routes don't loop. Get off and ride back.

Calls: Usually none. Mom, Dad, or Aunt if she's unsure where she is or it's getting dark.

Sources: Fairfax Connector: new rider guide · Fairfax Connector: fares and transfers · WMATA: transfers

8. I'm lost

Stopping beats wandering: she gets to a safe spot, lets the phone show where she is, sends that location to family, and takes an Uber home if finding the way feels like too much.

Help Now steps

1. Stop walking. Wandering usually makes it harder.
2. Go somewhere safe to stand: inside a store or café, or a busy, well-lit sidewalk.
3. Is your phone battery low (under about 20%)?
   - **Yes:** turn on Low Power Mode in Control Center, and skip to step 6 so you use the battery for what matters.
   - **No:** go to step 4.
4. Tap **Where am I?** in this app. It shows the blue dot on a map and the nearest street address.
5. Want to find the way yourself? Tap **Directions home** to open Apple Maps. Walking or transit both work.
6. Send your location: tap **Send my location to Mom** (or Dad or Aunt). It opens Messages with a map pin ready to send.
7. Rather not figure it out? Open Uber and request a ride home. Uber already knows where you are.
8. If you need to ask someone, ask a person who works there: a store clerk, a bus driver, or station staff.
9. If someone makes you feel unsafe, go into a busy store, or call 911.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Lost just means you don't know the way yet. Your phone does."
- (Sending location) "Now someone who loves you knows exactly where you are."
- (Uber) "Getting a ride is a smart choice, not giving up."

Practice: "You come out of a store and nothing looks familiar. What do you do first?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Stop, go somewhere safe, and check the map on my phone	Right	Yes. Standing still and checking is faster than wandering.

Choice	Result	Feedback
Keep walking until something looks familiar	Not this	You may walk farther away. Stop and check your phone first.
Ask a stranger on the street for a ride	Never	**Never take a ride from a stranger.** Use Uber, or call family to come.
Text Mom my location	Not first	Great to do, right after you get somewhere safe to stand.

Practice: "Your phone is at 8% and you're not sure where you are. What's the best use of your battery?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Low Power Mode, send my location to family, then call or order an Uber	Right	Yes. Save the battery for getting home.
Look up directions and walk with the map open	Not this	The map uses a lot of battery. Send your location first while you still can.
Scroll social media while I think	Not this	Save every bit of battery for getting home.

Calls: Mom, Dad, or Aunt (can come pick her up). 911 if she feels unsafe.

Sources: Apple: share your location with iPhone · Apple: location sharing options

9. Card declined at the register

A declined card is common and usually fixable in a minute; she gets a ready-made sentence to say, a second try, and a polite way to set the items aside if nothing works.

Help Now steps

1. Say: "Sorry, let me try again." Cashiers see this all the time.
2. Try once more: tap or insert the card instead of swiping, and check you entered the right PIN.
3. Still declined? Check your phone. Is there a text or app alert from your bank asking "Did you make this purchase?"

- **Yes, in the bank's app or from the bank's usual number:** answer yes, then try the card again.
- **No alert:** go to step 4.

4. Try another way to pay if you have one: Apple Pay with a different card, another card, or cash.
5. Nothing works? Say: "Could you set these aside for a few minutes? I need to sort out my card." Or just: "I'll come back for these." Either is fine.
6. Step away and text Mom or Dad. Later, call the number on the back of your card to find out why.

Anxious-mode lines

- "This happens to everyone. The cashier has seen it many times today."
- "You don't owe anyone an explanation. 'I'll come back' is enough."
- (Afterward) "It's a card problem, not a you problem. It can be fixed later."

Practice: "The card reader says DECLINED and there's a line behind you. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Say "let me try again," and tap or insert the card once more	Right	Yes. Many declines are a bad read or a typo.
Leave the store without saying anything	Not this	You can calmly say, "I'll come back for these." Nobody minds.
Keep trying the card over and over	Not this	Two tries is enough. Then check your phone or use another way to pay.
Check my phone for a bank alert	Not first	Good second step. Try once more first; it's often just a bad read.

Practice: "A text says your card was blocked. It has a link to 'verify your account.' What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Don't tap the link; check the bank's own app or call the number on my card	Right	Yes. Real bank alerts can be checked in the app. Links in texts can be scams.

Choice	Result	Feedback
Tap the link and enter my card number	Never	**Never enter card details from a text link.** Open the bank's app yourself instead.

Calls: Mom or Dad. The number on the back of the card, when she's away from the register.

Sources: Citi: why was my credit card declined · Money Crashers: card declined at checkout

10. Scam call or text

Scammers win by making people rush, so the whole scenario is about slowing down: hang up or don't reply, never tap links, and check with family or the real company using a number she already knows.

Help Now steps

1. Pause. Don't tap any link, reply, or press any number yet.
2. Does the message or call do any of these?
   - Says something is urgent: your account is locked, a package can't be delivered, you owe money, you'll be arrested.
   - Asks for a password, code, card number, or Social Security number.
   - Wants payment by gift card, cash app, or wire.
   - Offers a prize, refund, or free gift you didn't expect.
3. **If yes to any:** it's almost certainly a scam. Hang up, or don't reply. You're allowed to hang up on anyone.
4. Never share a code that was texted to you. Real companies never ask you to read one back.
5. Worried it might be real? Check yourself: open the company's own app, or call the number on your card or their official website. Never use the number or link in the message.
6. Tell Mom, Dad, or Aunt about it. Talking it through helps you see it clearly.
7. For a scam text: delete it. You can also forward it to 7726 (SPAM) first to report it.
8. If you already tapped a link, gave information, or paid: tell Mom or Dad right away. It's fixable, and acting quickly helps.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Scary messages are made to rush you. Slowing down is the right move."
- (Hanging up) "Hanging up isn't rude. It's how you stay safe."
- (Already clicked) "Scammers fool smart people every day. Telling someone now is exactly right."

Practice: "A text says: 'USPS: your package is on hold. Pay $1.99 at this link within 24 hours.' What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Don't tap; delete it, or forward it to 7726 first	Right	Yes. Rushing you and asking for a small fee by link are classic scam signs.
Tap the link; it's only $1.99	Never	**Never pay through a link in a surprise text.** They want your card number, not the $1.99.
Reply STOP	Not this	Replying tells scammers your number works. Just delete it.
Ask Mom whether I'm expecting a package	Right (allowed)	Good idea. If you are, check the tracking in the store's own app.

Practice: "A caller says he's from your bank and needs the code they just texted you. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Hang up, then call the number on the back of my card	Right	Yes. Banks never ask for those codes.
Read him the code so my account stays safe	Never	**Never read a texted code to anyone.** That code lets them into your account.
Ask him to prove he's from the bank	Not this	Scammers can sound very convincing. Just hang up and call the bank yourself.

Calls: Mom, Dad, or Aunt to talk it through. The number on her card, never the one in the message.

Sources: FTC: how to recognize and avoid phishing scams (archived) · FTC: 10 things you can do to avoid fraud

11. Carbon monoxide alarm

Carbon monoxide has no smell or color, so a CO alarm always means get outside to fresh air and call 911 from there, even if she feels fine or the alarm stops.

Help Now steps

1. Is it the CO alarm's loud repeating beeps, or a single chirp every minute?
   - **Loud repeating beeps:** go to step 2.
   - **Single chirp:** it needs a new battery or a new alarm. Tell Mom or Dad. You're safe.
2. Get outside now. Take your phone and pets if they're right there, but don't stop to look for anything.
3. Once outside, call 911. Say: "Our carbon monoxide alarm is going off and I'm outside." Tell them if you have a headache, feel dizzy, or feel sick.
4. Call Mom or Dad.
5. Stay outside, even if the alarm stops. If it's cold, wait in a neighbor's house or a car parked on the street, not in the garage.
6. Go back in only when the firefighters say it's safe.

Anxious-mode lines

- "You can't smell this, so the alarm is doing the noticing for you. Just go outside."
- (Outside) "Fresh air fixes it. You're doing exactly the right thing."
- (Waiting) "Firefighters check this all the time. They'll tell you when it's safe."

Practice: "The carbon monoxide alarm is beeping loudly, but you feel fine and don't smell anything. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Go outside, then call 911	Right	Yes. You can't smell carbon monoxide, so trust the alarm.
Press the button to silence it and go back to bed	Never	**Never ignore a CO alarm.** Feeling fine doesn't mean the air is safe. Go outside and call 911.

Choice	Result	Feedback
Look around the house for the cause	Not this	Leave finding the cause to firefighters. Your job is to get outside.
Wait inside to see if it stops	Not this	Even if it stops, the gas may still be there. Get outside first.

Calls: 911 from outside, every time. Then Mom or Dad.

Sources: Maine Emergency Management: CO alarm · Google Nest (quoting NFPA) · Carrier: if your CO detector goes off

12. I smell gas

Gas smells like rotten eggs on purpose, so she'll notice it. A spark can light it, so she leaves without touching switches, then calls from outside.

Help Now steps

1. Do you smell rotten eggs or sulfur, or hear a hissing sound? Treat it as gas.
2. Leave the house now. On the way out:
   - Don't turn any lights or switches on or off.
   - Don't use your phone inside the house.
   - Don't light anything, and don't use the garage door opener.
   - Leave the front door open behind you.
3. Walk well away from the house, like to the end of the driveway or a neighbor's yard.
4. Call 911. Then call the Washington Gas emergency leak line at 844-927-4427 and choose option 1. The number is in My People.
5. Call Mom or Dad.
6. Stay outside until the gas company or firefighters say it's safe.
7. Smell gas outdoors, not in a house? Walk away from it, then call 911 and the gas company.

Anxious-mode lines

- "That smell is there to warn you, and it worked. Just walk outside."
- (Outside) "You're safe out here. Now one phone call."
- (Waiting) "The gas company checks smells like this every day. They'll fix it."

Practice: "You walk into the kitchen and it smells like rotten eggs. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Leave without touching switches, then call from outside	Right	Yes. Get out first, call once you're away from the house.
Turn on the light to look for the leak	Never	**Never flip a switch when you smell gas.** A spark can light it. Leave in the dark if you have to.
Call 911 from the kitchen	Not this	Don't use your phone inside. Walk out first, then call.
Open all the windows before leaving	Not this	Don't spend time inside. Just leave the front door open as you go.

Calls: 911 and the gas company's emergency line, both from outside. Then Mom or Dad.

Sources: Washington Gas: safety · NBC Washington: what to do if you smell gas

13. Uber driver didn't show up or cancelled

A no-show is annoying but routine: she waits somewhere safe, checks the app, and requests another ride, with family as the backup if rides run out.

Help Now steps

1. Wait inside or somewhere comfortable until the app shows the driver has arrived.
2. Open the Uber app. Where is the car on the map?
   - **Still coming:** keep waiting. You can message the driver in the app if you need to.
   - **The car's here but you can't find it:** look for the plate number shown in the app, or message the driver.
   - **The ride was cancelled:** go to step 3.
3. Request a new ride. Cancellations happen a lot; it isn't your fault.
4. No cars available, or it's taking too long? Call Mom, Dad, or Aunt to come get you.
5. If someone offers you a ride and says they're an Uber driver but you didn't get matched in the app, say no. Uber rides only come through the app.
6. Charged a fee for a ride that never came? Report it in the app later. It doesn't need fixing right now.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Drivers cancel all the time. It's not about you."
- (Rebooking) "One tap and another car is on the way."
- (Calling family) "Asking for a ride is a good plan, not a failure."

Practice: "Your Uber cancels and a man in a car nearby says, 'I'm a driver, I can take you.' What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Say no, and request a new ride in the app	Right	Yes. Uber rides only come through the app.
Get in; he says he drives for Uber	Never	**Never get in a car you didn't match with in the app.** Anyone can say they drive for Uber.
Give up and walk home in the dark	Not this	Request another ride, or call family to come get you.

Calls: Mom, Dad, or Aunt if no ride is available. 911 if someone makes her feel unsafe.

Sources: Uber: rider safety tips

14. The car doesn't match the app

She checks three things before getting in (license plate, car, driver's face) and asks "Who are you here to pick up?"; if anything doesn't match, she doesn't get in.

Help Now steps

1. Before opening the door, check the app:
   - Does the **license plate** match?
   - Does the **car's make, model, and color** match?
   - Does the **driver look like the photo**?
2. Ask: "Who are you here to pick up?" Let the driver say your name. Don't say it for them.
3. Did everything match?
   - **Yes:** get in the back seat. Tap **Share trip status** in the app so Mom or Dad can follow along.
   - **No, or you're not sure:** go to step 4.

4. Don't get in. Say "Sorry, wrong car" and step back to a safe place, inside if you can.
5. Cancel the ride in the app and request a new one. Report the mismatch in the app later.
6. If anyone pressures you to get in, or follows you, go into a busy store and call 911. The Uber app also has an emergency button.
7. Already in the car and something feels wrong? You can ask to be let out at a busy, well-lit place, and you can call 911 from the app.

Anxious-mode lines

- "Checking is normal. Good drivers expect it."
- (Wrong car) "Saying no is always allowed. Another car is easy to get."
- (Matched) "Everything matched. Sit back; Mom or Dad can see your trip."

Practice: "A car pulls up, and the driver says, 'Are you Sam?' Your name isn't Sam, but the car color is right. What do you do?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
Ask "Who are you here to pick up?" and check the plate	Right	Yes. If the name or plate is wrong, it's not your ride.
Get in; the color matches	Never	**Check the plate, not just the color.** Many cars look alike. Never get in until everything matches.
Say "Yes, I'm Sam" to be polite	Never	Never agree to a name that isn't yours. Let the driver tell you who they're picking up.

Practice: "Where should you sit in an Uber?"

Choice	Result	Feedback
The back seat	Right	Yes. You can get out on either side, and you have your own space.
The front seat	Not this	The back seat is safer, especially when riding alone.

Calls: Mom or Dad (share the trip). 911 if she feels unsafe, from the phone or the Uber app.

Sources: Uber: Check Your Ride · Uber: rider safety tips

Sources

Each scenario lists its sources under it; the safety-critical steps rest on these official ones. Also used: Maine Emergency Management on CO alarms, Washington Gas safety, and Uber's Check Your Ride.

Topic	Source
Fire and smoke alarms	American Red Cross · Seattle Fire Dept.
Cooking fires	NFPA via Ashburn Volunteer Fire-Rescue · Cambridge Fire Dept.
Power outages	Ready.gov
Bus and Metro	Fairfax Connector · WMATA
Sharing location	Apple Support
Scams and locksmiths	FTC: avoid fraud · FTC: finding a locksmith (archived)

Open questions for Susan and the mentor

- [ ] **Carbon monoxide alarm and gas smell** weren't in the starter 10. Added as scenarios 11 and 12. Confirmed: the house has Washington Gas service; its emergency line is now in the call list.
- [ ] **Fire extinguisher:** the app never tells her to use one, only "lid on" or "get out." Keep it that way, or train her on it and add a branch?
- [ ] **Breaker reset:** comfortable with her doing this herself, or should scenario 5 always say "call Mom or Dad"?
- [ ] **Smoke alarm batteries:** the app says to tell Mom or Dad rather than climb up. Right call?
- [ ] **Paying for transit:** does she use a plastic SmarTrip card, SmarTrip in Apple Wallet, or a contactless bank card? The wording in scenario 7 should match.
- [ ] **Locked out:** are there other ways in (garage keypad, hidden key, a neighbor with a key) to note in My Home?
- [ ] **Practice questions with more than one good answer** (marked "Right (allowed)"): keep them, or make every question single-answer to keep it simple?

- [ ] **Tone:** do the anxious-mode lines sound like her, or should she help rewrite them in her own words?
- [ ] **Next scenarios:** Uber scenarios added as 13 and 14. Any other situations she names herself?